

**PISTONS
FIRING**
Detroit
beats Suns;
Sonics
rally past
Magic
C3



INDIANS

Dennis Martinez
to start opener
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HIGH SCHOOL

Erie Shore Conference
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Sports

The Chronicle / THURSDAY, MARCH 14, 1996 **C1**

Midview's exit from ESC hits snag

Roger Negin
The Chronicle-Telegram

When Midview switches leagues next year, it will not be with the blessing of the Erie Shore Conference.

Erie Shore principals, meeting Wednesday in Lorain, voted to uphold the league constitution and hold Midview to its obligation of giving the league two years' notice before withdrawing.

Three weeks ago, Midview accepted a spot in the Lorain County Conference and announced its intention of leaving the Erie Shore in the fall.

"They voted to release Midview as of the end of the 1996-97 school year," said ESC commissioner Dan Barringer, speaking of Erie Shore principals. "Midview requested to leave at the end of the current year, but there was no second to the motion. The

member schools were following the constitution of the Erie Shore."

The league constitution stipulates that withdrawing schools must give the league two years' notice — the current year and one more.

Sandusky is withdrawing after the 1996-97 year to join the Great Lakes League. In two years, the Erie Shore will be down to five schools.

"This is the first I've heard of this," said Midview athletic director Stan Hughes. "I should reserve comment until I learn more about it."

Principal Al Pavelschak represented Midview at the meeting, Hughes said.

Wednesday's vote did something else. It showed that there will be an Erie Shore Conference for the next school year.

League members are

Sandusky, Admiral King, Vermilion, Southview, Elyria and North Ridgeville.

"Midview is getting the same thing that Sandusky got," Barringer said.

However, the Erie Shore vote is merely a protest against the Lorain County Conference's move to bring in a new member for play next year.

Midview is replacing Elyria West, which is being closed, in

the LOC.

"Everybody was put into a bind with the Lorain County Conference vote. They've squeezed everybody," Barringer said. "I don't know of another conference in the state that doesn't uphold the two-year period. This has caused a headache for everyone."

See **MIDVIEW, C2**

Hargrove draws Harrah home

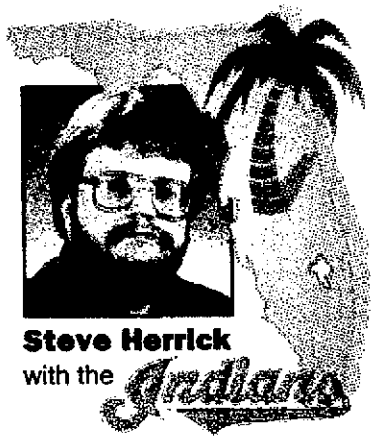
WINTER HAVEN, Fla. — The face of Cleveland baseball has changed considerably since Toby Harrah last wore an Indians uniform.

The team he has joined as the new infield and third base coach on Mike Hargrove's staff is a lot different than the one Harrah left following the 1983 season.

Harrah got a first-hand glimpse of the new and improved Indians while watching last season's playoffs and the World Series.

"I was so envious," he said. "Grover, Buddy Bell and Davey Nelson were all former teammates of mine. I thought, 'Wouldn't it be nice to be involved in something like that?' Getting to the World Series is the ultimate experience for everybody in the game."

Harrah might get that chance this season. Soon after the Series ended, Bell, the Tribe's infield



Steve Herrick
with the
Indians

coach in 1994 and '95, was hired to manage the Detroit Tigers. Hargrove called Harrah, who managed at Class AAA Norfolk last season, and asked him to join the Indians' staff. Bell also offered him a job, but Harrah decided to return to Cleveland.

See **INDIANS, C2**

Abdul-Rauf softening his stand on anthem?

Associated Press

DENVER — One of Mahmoud Abdul-Rauf's closest advisers is speculating that a statement issued by the Denver Nuggets guard is the first step in his attempt to be reinstated by the NBA.

Abdul-Rauf, suspended without pay for refusing to stand during the national anthem, issued a written clarification of his position, a statement that some interpreted as an attempt at being conciliatory.

"I think the statement may have been step one," Abdul-Rauf's confidante, speaking on condition of anonymity, told the Denver Post. "And I look for step two to happen today. I think he is going to say something that will get him back to playing basketball."

If Abdul-Rauf agrees to comply with NBA rules regarding the anthem, it may be because he

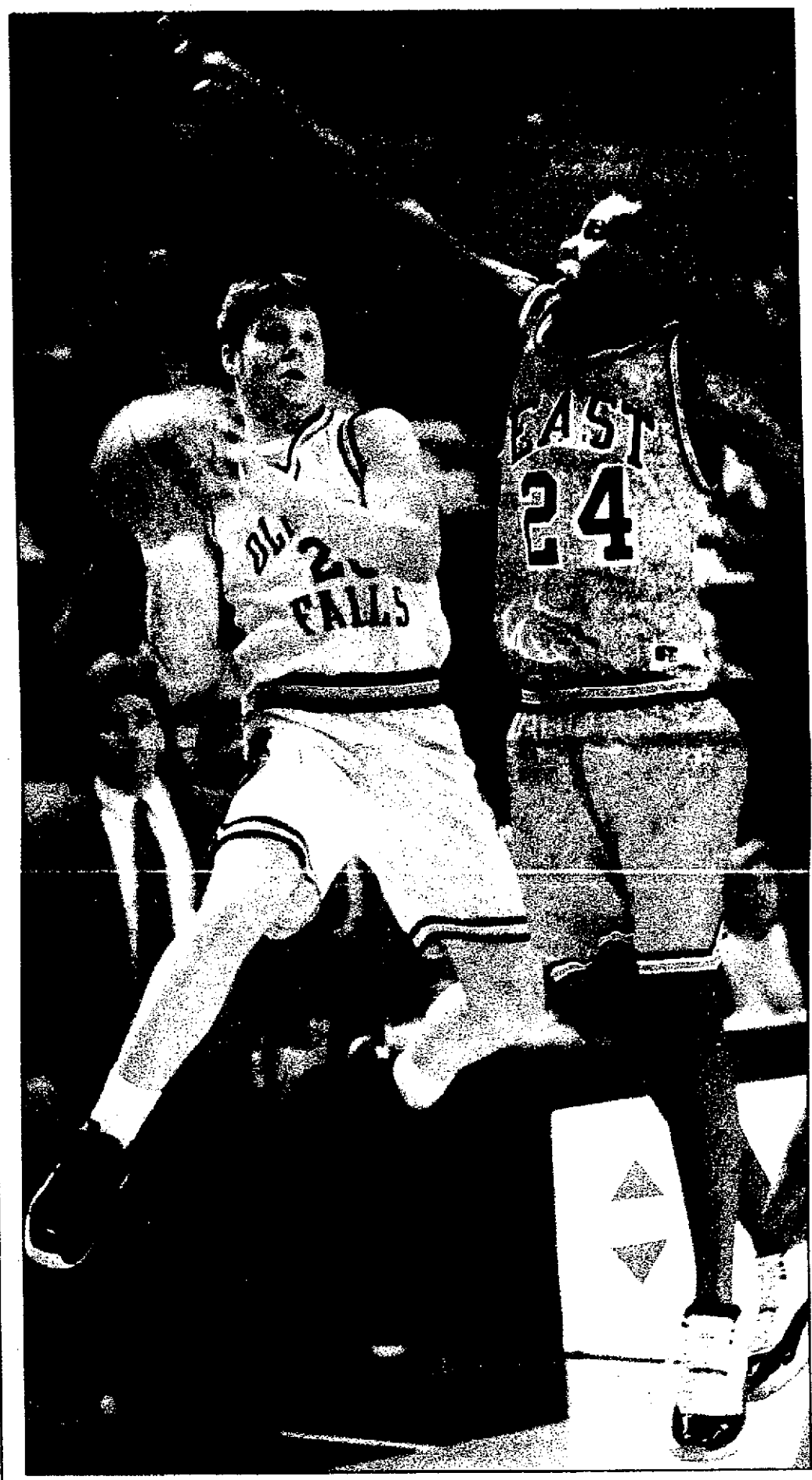
was convinced to change his position by other prominent Muslims.

He came under harsh criticism, even from within the Islamic community, for his stand on not standing. Kareem Abdul-Jabbar, the NBA's career leading scorer and a convert to Islam in the 1970s, phoned Abdul-Rauf and urged him to re-think his position. Houston Rockets center Hakeem Olajuwon, also a Muslim, emphasized his belief that the religion encourages respect for the flag.

Local Islamic leader Mohamad Jodeh urged Abdul-Rauf to reconsider his position.

Abdul-Rauf's statement, issued through his business manager, Shareef Nasir, made no mention of a possible change in his position, but read, in part, "... it is my intention to try and live a peaceful life, play basketball and

See **ANTHEM, C2**



KEN BLAZE / CHRONICLE

FINAL FLING: Olmsted Falls' Tim Matus fires a desperation shot over Columbus East's Albert Moore in the game's final moments.

Falls' rally fizzles in last minute

Tim Gebhardt
The Chronicle-Telegram

TOLEDO — It was a bitter disappointment Pat Donahue and his Olmsted Falls basketball team suffered Wednesday night at Toledo University's John Savage Hall.

Columbus East, winners of only five games prior to the start of sectional play two weeks ago, won its fifth straight tournament contest by knocking off the Bulldogs, 67-64, in a Division II regional semifinal.

East (10-13), losers of eight straight at one point, is now just one step away from going home for a chance at the Division II state title next week at St. John Arena in Columbus. But first, on Saturday they must beat Ottawa-Glandorf (23-1), which won Wednesday's opener over Lexington, 68-66, in two overtimes.

The opportunity for Olmsted Falls (21-3) to win its first regional game under Donahue in four tries was taken away by pure quickness and rebounding ability.

"They didn't play any way that surprised us," said Donahue. "They just did a better job at going to the boards than we did."

"We had some open shots. We missed some open shots. What can you do? I can't make any excuses for that. We had several wide-open looks and we just flat-out missed the shot."

The Tigers scored 13 times on stick-backs and outrebounded the Dogs, 45-23, including 23 offensive rebounds.

In the third period, East broke down Falls' defense by penetrating the lane and dishing off to the open man as they opened a 55-42 bulge.

Falls whittled the lead to 64-62 and appeared to have tied the game with 20 seconds left on Matt Tabar's layup off a turnover, but a back-court foul wiped out the basket. East responded with a Kyle Harrison stick-back with 12 seconds to play to ice the game.

Kent State-bound Albert Moore proved deadly both inside and out in scoring 26 points to lead East. Shawn Haley added 15 points and seven rebounds while Tarik Dear had a dozen of each. Harrison added 11 points.

Tim Schaefer, the Bulldog's 6-foot-8 junior, led the way with 18 points and 10 rebounds. Tabar added 14, all in the first half. John Storey came off the bench to score 14 and Falls' other twin-tower, Nick Neumeister, added 11.

However, Falls' deft shooting touch disappeared in the third period. After leading by as many as seven, 28-21, in the first half by shooting the 3 with authority, the Bulldogs couldn't connect in the third period.

See **FALLS, C4**



MARC LESTER / CHRONICLE

WITH A TWIST: Elyria Catholic's Steve Brush, right, on his way to a win in the 145-pound class.

Wrestling champs honored

Judie Asp
The Chronicle-Telegram

ELYRIA — Area wrestlers and fans gathered Wednesday to honor their state champions at the 16th Annual Lorain County All-Star Meet at Elyria Catholic.

Avon Lake champs Shawn Bristow (130) and Ryan Pallinger (215) were voted the county's Most Valuable Wrestlers by the Lorain County Wrestling Coaches and Officials Association.

"I didn't know if it would be me or Ryan so I'm happy they gave it to both of us," said Bristow. "I'm still having trouble believing all this. It didn't hit me that I won the state championship until Sunday morning. I was in shock. I've wanted to be a state champ ever since I was little."

Added Pallinger, "I'm glad we



Pallinger

both were recognized. The state recognition is nice too, but this is closer to home. They've been around me my whole career."

And what a career it has been for the Shoremen duo.

Bristow completed a 38-1 senior season and totaled 131 career victories. This season, Bristow held a 177-3 takedown edge.

Pallinger finished perfect at 37-0 with 27 pins and got his 100th career win in the state semifinals Saturday. The senior 215-pounder was never taken down this season while earning 64 takedowns.

Bristow, Pallinger and Elyria Catholic's Scott Burnett were presented plaques in the Coliseum, honoring them for their recent state titles. Burnett completed a perfect 38-0 sophomore year.

Southview claimed four All-Star championships Wednesday as state qualifiers Andy Alvarado (119) and Manoh Brown (152), and seniors Deon Moye (171) and

Dan Findley (275) all won.

Avon Lake had champs in Bristow (130), senior Jason Eisenmann (140), two-time state qualifier junior Erik Mathisen (189) and Pallinger (215).

Pallinger defeated Southview state placer Adrian Johnson in overtime. The score was tied 1-1 after regulation and two minutes of overtime. Pallinger won the coin toss and needed just five seconds to escape for the win.

Another entertaining match occurred at 125 pounds where Oberlin senior James Schuster needed an extra 32 seconds to get by Avon Lake's Keith Concar. Concar turned Schuster late in the final period to tie the contest at 5 and send it into overtime.

Burnett and senior state runner-up Steve Brush (145) won for the Panthers.

Additional winners were: Fireland's Matt Kovach (103), Scott Wacker (135) of Wellington, and

See **WRESTLING, C4**